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Suit describes death at Steward hospital

Fatal heart attack in waiting room shows cost of cuts, mismanagement

By Chris Serres
GLOBE STAFF

On a September evening in 2023, Jennifer Knight arrived at Good Samaritan Medical Center in Brockton struggling to breathe and suffering from chest pain. She told an emergency department nurse that she believed she was having a heart attack, but the nurse sent her to the registration line without evaluating her.

Twenty minutes later, the 37-year-old from Taunton collapsed and died.

The nurse, Holly Zachos, was fired over the incident but later rehired after the state's top health official intervened on her behalf. Her extraordinary reinstatement — detailed in a December 2024 Globe Spotlight Team investigation — raised questions about political favoritism, as Zachos is married to

George Zachos, a senior official in Governor Maura Healey's administration.

Now, three years later, a wrongful death lawsuit filed against Zachos and an emergency department physician offers fresh details about the incident. They are the only named defendants in a suit that underscores how relentless cost-cutting and severe understaffing at Good Samaritan's corporate owner — the once-high-flying, now defunct Steward Health Care system — put patient lives at risk.

According to the lawsuit, Knight

had grown so acutely ill while driving down Route 24 that she pulled off the highway and then sought help at Good Samaritan.

When Knight arrived at the hospital, she approached Zachos, the triage nurse in Good Samaritan's emergency department, and reported that she was having acute chest pain and shortness of breath, according to the suit. But Zachos sent her back to the registration line without checking her vital signs or otherwise evaluating her, according to a federal health investigation two

STEWARDS, Page A10

Nurses at BMC vote to allow strike

Authorization comes as hospital faces losses and cuts to federal funding

By Marin Wolf and Jonathan Saltzman
GLOBE STAFF

Nearly 2,000 nurses at Boston Medical Center voted overwhelmingly to authorize a three-day strike over pay and staffing at New England's largest safety-net hospital, their union said Friday.

The strike authorization, which passed with nearly 90 percent support, sets up a potentially expensive clash at the hospital with the region's busiest emergency department at a time when BMC is confronting financial losses and impending cuts to federal funding.

Despite working in one of the most challenging hospital environments, BMC nurses say they're among the lowest-paid in the city, making it difficult for the hospital to recruit and retain staff and leading to a feeling of burnout among members.

Nurses in 1199 of the Service Employees International Association and BMC management have been negotiating a new contract for more than six months with no success.

"We are a Level I trauma center," said Allison Chase, a post-anesthesia care unit nurse at BMC. "We should be paid like the other Level I trauma centers."

The BMC fight — which includes nurses at the

NURSES, Page A10



HEATHER KHALIFA/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Two columns of light, representing the World Trade Center, appeared on the floor inside the Oculus in New York City.

Amid tears, a vow to remember

Families, friends, officials gather to honor those killed on 9/11

By Brian MacQuarrie
GLOBE STAFF
and Chloe Craft and Bryan Hecht
GLOBE CORRESPONDENTS

Solemn pageantry, remembrances of the lost, and impassioned calls for national unity marked the state's commemorations Friday of the 25th anniversary of the Sept. 11, 2001, terror attacks.

On a beautiful, sunlit morning that recalled the day two hijacked passenger jets from Logan International Airport struck the World Trade Center in New York, the names of 219 victims with Massachusetts connections were read one by one from the steps of the State House by family members and others.

In all, hijackings involving four planes that day killed 2,977 victims in New York, the Pentagon, and Shanksville, Pa.

"Each name represents a life, a beloved family member, friend, colleague, and neighbor who was taken far too soon. And behind each name are families and friends whose lives were forever changed by their loss,"

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ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

Grace Castro, 5, and her father, Jairo Castro, at the 9/11 memorial in Boston. Jairo Castro's mother, Gricelda James, was killed in the attack.

MAGA faithful weigh future beyond Trump

For some at convention, prospect is 'kind of scary'

By Sam Brodey and James Pindell
GLOBE STAFF

DALLAS — Republicans proudly billed their 2026 midterm convention as "Trump-a-palooza," with the two-day event largely dedicated to celebrating the president, his image inescapable everywhere from arena hallways to press badges.

But the GOP's gathering in Texas could be more significant for a different reason: as the party's first glimpse — one that is hazy, anxious, and uncertain — of life after Trump.

For many of the MAGA faithful who attended, where hats and shirts saying "Trump 2028" were common, the prospect was painful to contemplate.

Or worse. "It is kind of scary," remarked Jorjette Bostrom, a convention delegate from Nampa, Idaho, when asked about the post-Trump future.

Still, the undercurrent of change was inescapable from the halls of the American Airlines Center to the main stage, just 54 days from the 2026 election — and 55 from the unofficial start of the 2028

CONVENTION, Page A7

Phones may be tool to predict suicide risk

By Sarah Rahal
GLOBE STAFF

For decades, clinicians treating patients with serious mental illness have struggled with two critical questions: Who is most likely to attempt suicide and when?

A new study from Harvard researchers suggests that frequent smartphone check-ins could help clinicians detect changes in a patient's emotional state that signal heightened risk.

The technique they developed predicted that risk with exceptional accuracy: It identified 75 percent of suicide attempts and 87 percent of suicide-related events like hospitalizations in the week before they occurred.

Researchers followed 619 adults and adolescents who had sought care for suicidal thoughts or behavior at two Boston-area hospitals. Participants received 20-question surveys on their smartphones six times a day for three months. On a sliding scale from 1 to 10, they were asked how they felt at that moment — how hopeless they felt, how agitated they were, how strong their urge to kill themselves was, and how capable they felt of resisting that urge.

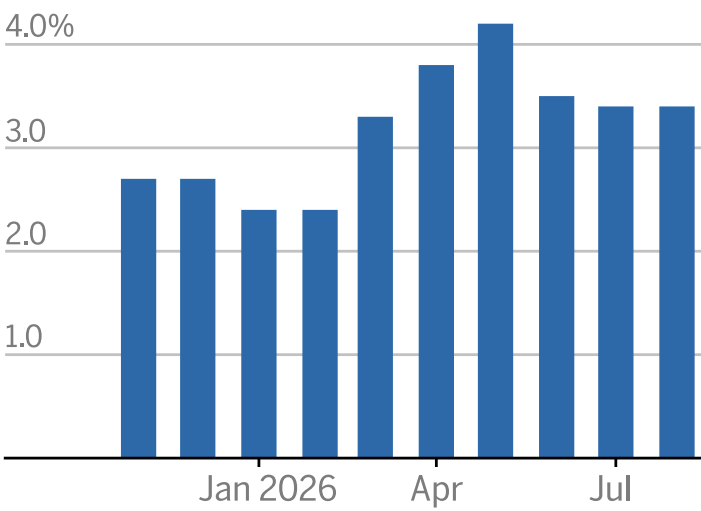
Researchers combined the answers with information about how and when people completed the surveys and fed

SUICIDE, Page A6

Inflation sticks around

The consumer price index report showed overall inflation at an annual pace of 3.4 percent, bolstering the case for the Federal Reserve to raise interest rates at its meeting next week. **D1.**

The annual percentage change in prices since November 2025



Data for October 2025 was not collected due to the government shutdown.
Chart: RYAN HUDDLE/GLOBE STAFF • Source: US Department of Labor



One fine day

Saturday: Mostly sunny. High: 71-76. Low: 62-67

Sunday: Heavy rain. High: 72-77. Low: 65-70.

Sunrise: 6:21 Sunset: 6:59

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UK lawmakers voted down legislation to allow terminally ill adults in England and Wales to choose to end their lives. **A3.**

Incumbent state Senator William N. Brownsberger was declared the winner of the Democratic primary for the Suffolk and Middlesex District, beating Daniel Lander by 35 votes. **B1.**

Residents and elected officials packed the first of four planned community meetings to talk about the redesign of Blue Hill Avenue, with many speaking against the latest plan. **B1.**

The Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services released guidance for states allowing them to use a "tier system" to determine which Medicaid recipients are too ill to work or volunteer at least 20 hours per week. **D1.**